



The Anarchist Book Club (ABC), to avoid invasion by Campists and Vanguardists, is in need of grounding principles upon which the group is centered. These are subject to discussion and change should any of them prove to pull us further from our primary goals.

Andrew Sage
**"Revolution isn't a
game of follow-the-
leader."**

PLURALISM

As stated before, plurality is a core value of ABC. As such, we do not discriminate politically (outside some egregious cases such as racism and fascism). Whether you come to the discussion from the perspective of a big L Libertarian, a Voluntarist Communist, a disenfranchised Republican or Democrat, or (of course) among any of the many forms of anarchism (Nihilist, Queer, Collectivist, Individualist, &c.), you are welcome here so long as you respect the function and values of ABC. We won't tolerate explicit and unapologetic bigotry (racism, sexism, transphobia, homophobia, &c.), regardless of who it's directed at.

Among our values, we hold highest Plurality and Anti-Authoritarianism. Plurality means an acceptance of many ideas, acknowledging there is no one universal answer to all our problems. This means hearing out perspectives we disagree with, listening to a variety of experiences, and working through the very real consequences we might see. Anti-Authoritarianism means a rejection of domination, subjugation, and centralization. Anarchism holds a long history of standing against authoritarian politics (as well as being burned by those who practice them). These two are held first and foremost in the struggle against oppression.

VALUES

Beyond these values, ABC holds to the importance of both collective and individual liberty, that one cannot be fully realized without the other. For the collective to be "free" but not the individual, the individual must be oppressed, making this freedom hollow. For the individual to be "free" but not the collective, the collective must be oppressed, making this freedom meaning-less. This is why the struggle is viewed as intersectional.

ABC functions as a decentralized group; there is no central leadership, no elections or passing-the-baton. Decisions are made by those affected by the outcome; consensus must be reached for a change to take place. This can be consensus among one reading group of the club as to what to read or whether to participate in local action, or it can be made across the club to codify a central value that is not currently in application. Regardless, a commitment to consent of all involved is centered above all else.

FUNCTION

GOALS

The goal of anarchism is simple - abolition of hierarchical control, whether it be state, social, or religious authority imposed over another. While this is a general goal which the group is tangentially aligned with, it's not the group's specific goal.

ABC seeks to broaden knowledge of anarchism, discussing theory and praxis; that is, the ideas and the practical application of the ideas. Anarchism is an oft misunderstood politic; it's regularly demonized by the political elite and the part-yist political groups who make hollow calls for "left unity". ABC is hoping to change that perspective on the individual and community level, to understand the human aspect of anarchy and goals of equity and inclusion.